

Salesforce Architect Preparation Track Syllabus

Archer Infotech, Kothrud Pune | Classroom & live-online batches | Updated September 2026

Course Overview

This syllabus lists every module of the course in teaching order, with the topics covered in each. It is generated from the course page, so the two cannot disagree.

Module 1: What an Architect Is Accountable For

Schedule: Week 1

The remit, and the shift that people moving up find hardest. An architect is accountable for decisions whose consequences arrive in two years, made with incomplete information, and defended to people who each want something different. The deliverable is a decision plus the reasoning, not a build.

The architect specialisms — application, integration, data, security, identity, system — and how they connect. You bring a real design you have made and the course examines it.

Topics

- What an architect owns beyond a solution design
- Deciding under incomplete information
- Architecture decision records and reasoning
- The architect specialisms and how they connect
- Domain architect versus technical architect
- Working with enterprise architecture functions
- Governance bodies and design authority
- Presenting a design examination of your own work

Module 2: Application Architecture & Large-Scale Design

Schedule: Weeks 2–3

Designing something that survives its third year and its fourth team. Declarative-versus-programmatic as an architectural policy rather than a per-story decision; separation of concerns in Apex; and the trigger, service and domain layer patterns that keep a large org's code navigable.

Single-org against multi-org: the arguments on both sides, the org-merge scenario, and why the answer is usually organisational rather than technical. Package strategy, technical debt as an actively managed quantity, and designing explicitly for the team that inherits it.

Topics

- Declarative-versus-programmatic as policy
- Separation of concerns and Apex layering
- Trigger, service and domain patterns at scale
- Single-org versus multi-org strategy
- Org merge and divestiture scenarios
- Unlocked packages and modularisation
- Technical debt as a managed quantity
- Designing for the team that inherits the org
- Reference architectures and standards

Module 3: Data Architecture & Large Data Volumes

Schedule: Weeks 3–4

Where Salesforce architecture becomes genuinely specialised. Data modelling for scale, skew — ownership, lookup and account data skew — and the locking and sharing-recalculation problems each causes at volume.

Large data volume techniques: selective queries, custom indexes, skinny tables, divisions, archiving strategy and the mechanics of sharing recalculation. Master data management, system of record decisions across an estate, and data retention and residency under Indian and international requirements.

Topics

- Data modelling for scale
- Ownership, lookup and account data skew
- Record locking and sharing recalculation
- Selective queries and custom indexes
- Skinny tables and divisions
- Archiving and data lifecycle strategy
- Master data management and system of record
- Data retention, residency and sovereignty
- Data Cloud in an architecture

Module 4: Integration Architecture

Schedule: Weeks 5–6

The specialism that most defines a Salesforce architect's value. The integration patterns — request-reply, fire-and-forget, batch data synchronisation, remote call-in, UI update based on data changes — with the capability, limits and failure behaviour of each.

Middleware and enterprise service bus decisions; event-driven architecture with platform events and Change Data Capture; API limit budgeting across an estate; and error handling, retry, idempotency and reconciliation at a scale where a failed message cannot simply be re-run by hand.

Topics

- The Salesforce integration patterns and their limits
- Choosing a pattern from volume, latency and coupling
- Middleware and enterprise service bus decisions
- Event-driven architecture at estate scale
- Platform events and Change Data Capture
- API limit budgeting across integrations
- Error handling, retry and idempotency
- Reconciliation and eventual consistency
- Integration security and credential management

Module 5: Identity & Access Management Architecture

Schedule: Week 7

Identity as an architectural domain rather than a configuration task. SAML, OAuth 2.0 flows and OpenID Connect; single sign-on with Salesforce as service provider and as identity provider; just-in-time provisioning and SCIM.

External identity for customer and partner communities, delegated authentication, and the session and device policies that follow. Designed against real constraints — a workforce identity provider, a customer base, and an audit requirement that all three must satisfy simultaneously.

Topics

- SAML and assertion handling
- OAuth 2.0 flows and choosing between them
- OpenID Connect and identity federation
- Salesforce as service provider and identity provider

- Just-in-time provisioning and SCIM
- External identity for communities
- Delegated authentication
- Session, device and MFA policy
- Designing identity against audit requirements

Module 6: Security Architecture & Compliance

Schedule: Week 8

Security designed rather than configured. The sharing architecture at scale — organisation-wide defaults, hierarchy, sharing rules, apex sharing and territory-driven access — and how to keep it comprehensible when several mechanisms overlap.

Platform encryption and its functional trade-offs, Event Monitoring and Shield, field audit trail, and designing to a compliance requirement rather than to a checklist. Threat modelling for a Salesforce estate closes the module.

Topics

- Sharing architecture at scale
- Apex sharing and manual sharing at volume
- Territory-driven access design
- Platform encryption and its trade-offs
- Shield, Event Monitoring and audit trail
- Designing to a compliance requirement
- Threat modelling a Salesforce estate
- Third-party and AppExchange risk assessment
- Security review for managed packages

Module 7: Performance, Scalability & Resilience

Schedule: Week 9

Making it hold up. Governor limits as an architectural budget across an estate rather than a per-transaction constraint; asynchronous design and queue management; and the performance characteristics of large orgs that behave nothing like a development environment.

Load testing, monitoring and observability; disaster recovery, backup and the honest position that Salesforce's own backup provisions are not a recovery strategy; and release and environment strategy across a large delivery organisation.

Topics

- Governor limits as an estate-level budget
- Asynchronous design and queue management
- Performance characteristics of large orgs
- Load testing and profiling approaches
- Monitoring and observability
- Backup, recovery and Salesforce's actual provisions
- Business continuity and disaster recovery
- Release and environment strategy at scale
- Sandbox strategy for a large programme

Module 8: AI Architecture — Agentforce, Data Cloud & Governance

Schedule: Week 10

The newest architectural domain, and one where the honest answers matter most because organisations are buying ahead of readiness. Agentforce architecture — agents, actions, grounding and the data path behind them — and what has to be true before any of it produces value.

Data Cloud in an enterprise architecture, AI governance, model and prompt security, prompt injection in an agent that holds real permissions, and the consent and privacy requirements. The recurring architectural answer is the one our career guide gives: AI sits on top of strong CRM, data and platform foundations, and an architect's job is often to say so.

Topics

- Agentforce architecture — agents, actions, grounding
- The data path behind a grounded agent
- Data Cloud in an enterprise architecture
- AI governance and model risk
- Prompt injection in an agent holding permissions
- Action scoping and least privilege for agents
- Consent, privacy and AI data flows
- Evaluating AI readiness honestly
- Advising against premature AI investment

Module 9: Design Reviews, Communication & Influence

Schedule: Week 11

The half of architecture that has nothing to do with the platform. Running a design review that surfaces the real risk rather than performing agreement; presenting to a steering committee; and writing an architecture decision record someone can follow after you have left.

Influence without authority — an architect usually cannot instruct anyone — and the specific skill of disagreeing with a senior stakeholder while keeping the relationship. Practised through review role-play on each other's designs.

Topics

- Running a design review that surfaces real risk
- Presenting architecture to a steering committee
- Architecture decision records that outlive you
- Influence without direct authority
- Disagreeing with a senior stakeholder
- Trade-off communication to non-technical audiences
- Mentoring developers and consultants
- Building consensus across delivery teams

Module 10: Architect Credential Preparation & Portfolio

Schedule: Week 12 + review cycle

Preparation for the Architect credential path — the domain architect examinations and the review-board format, which assesses a presented design under questioning rather than a multiple-choice paper and is a genuinely different discipline.

You build and present a full reference architecture for a complex scenario: data model, integration landscape, identity design, security architecture, scalability approach and a documented set of decisions with their trade-offs. Reviewed the way a board reviews.

Topics

- The Architect credential path and its structure
- Domain architect examination preparation
- The review-board format and what it assesses
- Building a full reference architecture
- Documenting decisions and trade-offs
- Presenting under sustained questioning
- Handling a challenge you had not anticipated
- Portfolio of architecture work for interviews

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